INCH-POUND

A-A-50115A
February 21, 1990
SUPERSEDING
A-A-50115
March 31, 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PITON, MOUNTAIN, CLIFFHANGER

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

1. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

1.1 Design and construction. The cliffhanger piton shall be chrome-molybdenum alloy 4130 steel. The pitons shall be capable of withstanding a force of 600 pounds when tested as specified in 2.4. The finish shall be black oxide, and the maximum weight shall be 1.5 ounces. The manufacturer's identification symbol shall be permanently marked on the piton. Pitons shall be similar to figure 1, which is for illustrative purposes only and is not intended to preclude procurement of pitons otherwise meeting all the requirements of this document.

1.2 Dimensions. The thickness of the piton shall be 0.125 ± 0.004 inch overall except the end of the hook shall be tapered. The hook end shall have a radius of 0.750 ± 0.062 inch. The base of the cliffhanger shall be curved to create a bipod base. The curved width of the base shall be 1.125 ± 0.040 inches tapering uniformly to a width of 0.420 ± 0.020 inch at the end of the hook. The base shall have two holes. A large hole of 0.370 ± 0.020 inch diameter at the base and a smaller hole of 0.330 ± 0.020 inch diameter located directly above the large hole. The maximum length from the top of the hook to the base shall be 3.5 inches.

2. QUALITY ASSURANCE

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Commander, U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014.

AMSC N/A FSC 8465

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2.1 Certification. The contractor shall certify, and maintain substantiating evidence, that the product offered meets the salient characteristics and requirements of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

2.2 Visual examination. Each lot of pitons shall be inspected in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0. The lot size shall be expressed in units of pitons. The sample unit shall be one piton. The pitons shall be examined for the defects listed below:

Finish not smooth and adherent; not free of burrs, rough spots, sharp edges, slivers, flat areas or projections; any component missing or not specified type; any component fractured, split, dented, bowed, malformed, damaged or loose; fillets not rounded smoothly, not free of forging lap, blade tapers not uniform; markings in wrong location, incomplete, illegible, incomplete, or not as specified.

2.3 Dimensional examination. The pitons shall be examined without damaging or disassembling the pitons. Any dimension not within the specified tolerances shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of pitons. The sample unit shall be one piton. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

2.4 Testing. The cliffhanger pitons shall be pull tested by hanging the piton on a 90-degree fixed corner. A 600-pound force shall be applied downward using a hook or link having a diameter of 3/8 $\pm$ 1/32 inch. Any piton that fails to withstand a minimum force of 600 pounds without permanent deformation shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be all pitons offered for delivery at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Any test failure shall be cause for rejection of the lot. The test shall be performed at room temperature. Any industrial testing machine may be used to determine compliance with this requirement.

3. PACKAGING

3.1 Packaging. Eight pitons shall be packaged in an intermediate box. The intermediate box shall be snug-fitting and fabricated from 200-pound test corrugated fiberboard.

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3.2 Packing. Three hundred and twenty pitons packaged as specified, shall be packed in a close-fitting corrugated fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be completely filled with no voids and of a size that can be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

3.3 Palletization. When specified (see 4.2), pitons, packed as specified, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C and D, or film bonding means F or G, in accordance with MIL-STD-147.

3.4 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or purchase order, intermediate boxes, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

4. NOTES

4.1 Intended use. The cliffhanger piton is intended to be used to provide direct aid for personnel in operations involving steep ascents by hooking the cliffhanger piton on rock edges and flakes.

4.2 Order data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When palletization is required (see 3.3).

4.3 Sources of documents.

4.3.1 Source of government documents. Copies of military and Federal documents are available from:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

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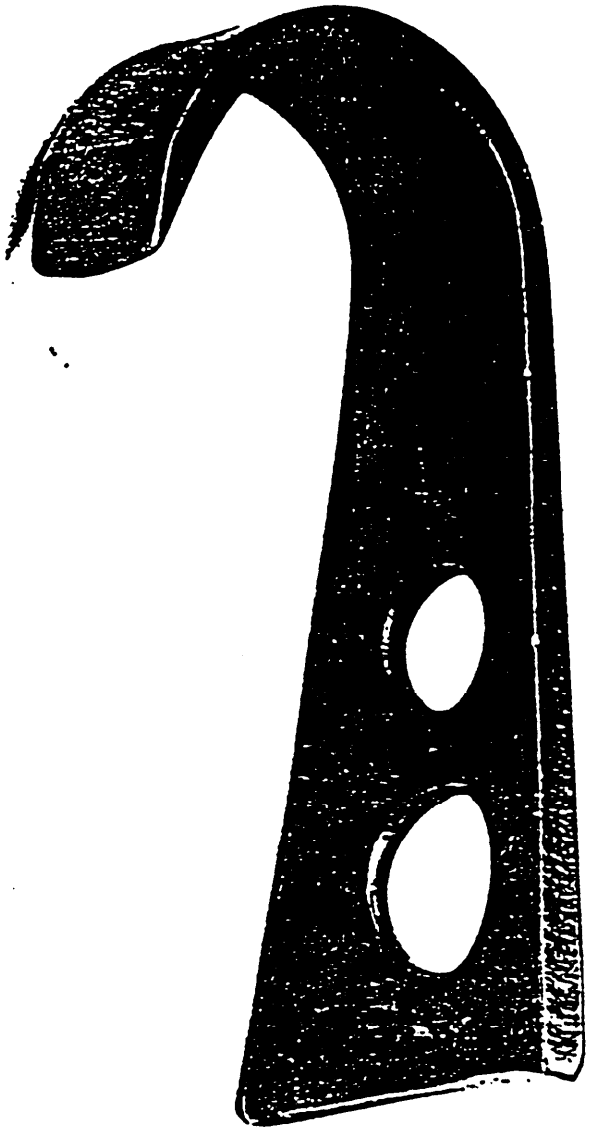


FIGURE 1. Piton, Mountain, Cliffhanger.

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